



Creative Skill Development

Administrative Details

Unit Code & Name: CIM301 Creative Skill Development

Awards: Diploma of Music, Associate Degree of Music, Bachelor of Music

Award Level: AQF 7

Delivery mode: Face to Face, Blended, Online

Course Committee: School of Sound Committee

Duration: 13 Weeks

Prerequisites: 80CP

Core or Elective: Elective

Credit Points: 10

Course Outcomes: Course Overviews

Unit Overview

Developing new creative skills, and refining existing ones, is a core part of building a sustainable creative practice. For creative media practitioners, this means not only improving craft, but learning how to identify industry-relevant skills, set meaningful goals, work with intention, and reflect on progress over time. These are the habits that allow creative practice to grow and adapt alongside changing technologies, industries, and personal ambitions.

In this unit, you will undertake a process of skills self-reflection and industry analysis to identify an area of your practice you would like to develop. You will explore approaches to goal setting, deliberate practice, and reflective thinking, and apply these ideas through a self-directed creative project. In small groups, and with guidance from a mentor, you will plan, implement, and evaluate your own development process.

Rather than focusing on a single outcome, this unit is about building tools and ways of working you can carry forward into your creative life. By the end of the trimester, you will have a clearer sense of direction, a stronger understanding of how you learn and grow as a practitioner, and a practical framework for ongoing creative development. At its core, this unit is about teaching you how to be able to teach yourself, enabling your own skills development throughout your career.

Unit Learning Outcomes

LO Code	Learning Outcome
LO1	Design and implement a self-directed learning pathway tailored to a chosen area of upskilling.
LO2	Demonstrate proficiency in applying newly acquired knowledge and skills to a practical creative industries project.
LO3	Reflect on the learning process and outcomes, identifying areas of growth and opportunities for further development.

Student Workload

The learning outcomes in this unit can be achieved in approximately 120 hours over 13 weeks. Learning activities will normally include: face-to-face learning on campus or online, self-paced online learning, research and investigation, practising skills, completing assessment tasks, working with fellow students, self-directed study and transferable skills.

Schedule

Week	Topic	Delivery	Project Due
1	Introduction to Being an Autodidact & Foundations of Deliberate Practice	National Class	
2	Industry Skills Analysis & Identifying Personal Skills Gaps	National Class	
3	SMARTER Goal Setting & Designing Your Deliberate Practice Plan	National Class	
4	Mentorship & Professional Relationships + First Mentor Group Session	Supervisor session	
5	Further Deliberate Practice, Reflective Assessment & Project Planning (Gantt Charts)	National Class	
6	Skill Diversification, Income Streams & Project Proof of Concept	National Class	Project 1
7	Project Week		
8	Wellbeing & Career Sustainability in the Creative Industries Supervisor Session: Project development	Supervisor session	
9	Positive Mental Attitude - Building Mental Habits for Progress Supervisor Session: Project development	Supervisor session	
10	Your Portfolio as a Resume Supervisor Session: Project development	Supervisor session	

11	AI and Emerging Technology and the Creative Media Industries Supervisor Session: Project development	Supervisor session	
12	Project Presentations	Supervisor session	Project 2
13	Guest Lecture & Unit Wrap Up	National Class	

Holistic Assessment

At SAE, assessments encourage students to investigate solutions to real-world problems and construct knowledge from inquiry-based processes and collaborative activities. Your facilitator will assess your work holistically throughout the unit.

1. To achieve a pass:

- **All projects must be submitted to be eligible for a Pass grade in the unit overall.**
- **All learning outcome requirements in each project brief must be met.**

2. Grades above a pass: Once the pass threshold for a project has been met, the standard of the project requirements will be holistically assessed (Pass, Credit, Distinction and High Distinction).

3. Unit Grade: Your final grade will be the average of your project grades.

Late Submissions & Special Consideration

If you have questions or difficulties with your assessments, speak to your facilitator as soon as possible. To request an extension or alternative assessment, use the [Special Consideration form](#).

Learn more about assessment at SAE in your [Student Handbook](#), including info on:

- Project grades
- Late Submissions & Special Consideration
- Assessment Re-mark
- Academic Integrity
- Group Work Agreement

Project Overview

Project	Starts	Deadline	Learning Outcomes	Transferable Skills	Graduate Attributes
Project 1	Week 1	Week 6	LO1-3	1-6	6,7
Project 2	Week 1	Week 12	LO1-3	1-6	6,7

Project 1 Brief

CIM301.1 Creative Skill Development Plan

Due	Week 6
Group / Individual Project	Individual
Artificial Intelligence Use	Level 2 — AI-Assisted Idea Generation and Structuring See AI Assessment Scale below

Overview:

Creative media practitioners need to continually develop and refine their skills in order to remain employable, adaptable, and creatively engaged. This project is designed to help you take ownership of that process by identifying a specific area of your practice you wish to improve, and designing a structured plan to develop that skill through deliberate, focused practice.

In this project, you will analyse the demands of your chosen area of practice by engaging with current industry examples and practitioner approaches, and reflect on your own existing skill set in relation to these expectations. Drawing on principles of goal setting and deliberate practice, you will then design a Creative Skill Development Plan that outlines what you intend to practice, how you will practice it, and why this approach is appropriate for your goals. The emphasis is on iteration, refinement, and learning through doing, rather than producing a single polished outcome.

You will create a proof of concept asset that demonstrates how your deliberate practice approach will translate into practical outcomes. This proof of concept functions as an initial test of your plan and forms the foundation for Project 2, where you will carry out the full practice process.

By the end of this project, you should have a clear, realistic, and industry-informed template for developing a specific creative skill through sustained practice in the future.

Project Goals:

To develop a deliberate practice plan for improving a skill, technique or knowledge area of your choice, relevant to your creative media practice and career aspirations. **Your project must centre around *practice* rather than *theory*:** you must produce a collection/portfolio of creative work that demonstrates the application and development of a new skill or technique, or the application of new knowledge within your creative practice.

Project Outline:

Use the [Project Documentation template](#) to document the steps outlined below, present your plan and research using visual/written materials (e.g., posters, mood boards):

Phase Overview	What You Need To Do	Checkpoint
Define Your Focus Choose an area to develop your practice and identify the key skills that are important in that area	- Define the area of practice you personally want to develop - Identify important skills and practices in that area, supported by at least 3 practitioner examples or sources. - Create a short skills self-analysis (e.g. annotated list, table, or diagram) comparing these skills to your own	Week 2 — Peer Feedback Focus: Idea and skills analysis
Deliberate	Outline the assets you'll	Week 4 —

Practice Plan Plan what you'll create to help you develop three of these skills	create to practice these skills - Identify at least 3 learning resources you'll use (e.g. tutorials, readings, practitioners) - Create a schedule or timeline (e.g. Gantt chart)	Mentor Feedback Focus: scope and resources
Proof of Concept Create a small asset to test your plan and identify refinements or additional assets needed before Project 2	- Produce a test asset embedded in an accessible format - Demonstrate what you intend to deliver in Project 2 - Document what worked, what didn't, and what needs refining or gathering before full production	Week 6 — Campus Online Submission

Deliverables: What to Submit

1. [Project Documentation template \(PDF\)](#) with proof of concept embedded in an accessible, examinable format. All referencing must adhere to APA7 standards.

AI Use

Any use of AI tools must be employed ethically and responsibly. Inappropriate use of AI tools, such as the inclusion of unattributed AI-generated text, is considered a breach of academic integrity. Please adhere to the following guidelines:

- The use of assistive creative media technology is permitted only when students thoroughly explain its intended purpose and functionality.
- Any usage of AI should be cited as outlined in the Library guide APA7 and AI guide

How You are Graded:

Learning Outcomes	Requirements
LO1: Design and implement a self-directed learning pathway tailored to a chosen area of upskilling.	• A development plan that clearly outlines your intended process and outcomes, with clear alignment to the Deliberate Practice model • Industry skills research that is recent and relevant to your career aspirations. • Research is evident and applies APA7 referencing with a minimum of 3 authoritative references required.
LO2: Demonstrate proficiency in applying newly acquired knowledge and skills to a practical creative industries project.	• Submitted proof of concept media assets that link to the Creative Skill Development Plan and demonstrate the area of skills to be developed. • Proof of concept media assets display work-in-progress prototypes of creative media project material.
LO3: Reflect on the learning process and outcomes, identifying areas of growth and opportunities for further development	• Documentation of testing process (what worked, what didn't, refinements needed). • Clear identification of areas of growth and opportunities for future development. • Skills self-analysis comparing your abilities with practitioner examples and/or research

Project 2 Brief

CIM301.2 Development Portfolio

Due	Week 12
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Group / Individual Project	Individual
Artificial Intelligence Use	Level 2 — AI-Assisted Idea Generation and Structuring See AI Assessment Scale below

Overview

This project is the practical continuation of the Creative Skill Development Plan you designed in Project 1. Where the first project focused on planning and testing an approach to deliberate practice, this project centres on carrying that plan out through sustained, focused creative work. You will commit to a regular practice routine, apply feedback, and track your progress as you develop a portfolio of creative assets.

Across the trimester, you will engage in deliberate practice for a minimum of four hours per week, spread across multiple sessions. Through this process, you will move beyond isolated exercises and into the sustained development of skill, technique, and reflection.

The final portfolio should demonstrate clear progress from your starting point, showing how your skills have evolved through practice, feedback, and reflection. Accompanying the creative work, you will document your development process, reflect on mentor and peer feedback, and produce an exegesis that unpacks your experience of undertaking a deliberate practice project. Together, these elements form a record of growth that highlights not only what you made, but demonstrates your awareness of how and why your practice developed throughout the project.

Project Goals

Produce and present a portfolio of creative work that demonstrates deliberate practice and progress on your Project 1 plan. You are expected to carry out **four hours per week of deliberate practice**, spread out across at least two days (ideally three). Accompanying the portfolio, you will use the [Project Documentation template](#) to:

- Build a **Development Log** by documenting your deliberate practice sessions through a combination of writing, screenshots, photos and videos.
- Log and reflect on mentor and peer **feedback**.
- Write an **exegesis** of the portfolio, unpacking the body of material, and discussing your overall experience of undertaking the

deliberate practice project.

Steps to Follow

Step	What You Need to Do / Evidence
Asset & Portfolio Development	• Develop the assets outlined in your plan from Project 1 • Keep a development log of your creative process (drafts, mock-ups, development material)
Collect Mentor and Peer Feedback	• Meet with your mentor at least twice to discuss progress • Collect feedback from mentor and peers, and summarise key insights and action items • Apply the feedback to refine your project and document your changes
Write and Present Project Exegesis (750 words)	• Introduce and summarise your project's purpose and approach • Conclude with key outputs and their link to project goals • Reflect on successes, challenges, feedback applied, and future goals • Reference core readings and research and how they helped (APA7) • Present a 5–7 minute summary of your project to peers and facilitator

Deliverables: What to Submit

1. [Project documentation template](#) (PDF) including:
 - **Assets** embedded in an accessible format
 - **Development Log** presented in easily digestible visual

format

- **Feedback** summaries and action items
- A 750-word project **exegesis** with reflections and APA-referenced sources.

2. Engagement in at least two mentor meetings.

Requirements: How your Project will be graded

Learning Outcomes	Threshold Requirements
LO1 Design and implement a self-directed learning pathway tailored to a chosen area of upskilling.	• Project assets clearly follow from the Project 1 plan. • Evidence of deliberate practice (drafts, iterations, process documentation). • Demonstrates initiative in directing own learning and skill focus.
LO2 Demonstrate proficiency in applying newly acquired knowledge and skills to a practical creative industries project.	• Completed assets show technical and creative improvement. • Work aligns with industry standards. • Feedback from mentors/peers has been incorporated into the final outcomes.
LO3 Reflect on the learning process and outcomes, identifying areas of growth and opportunities for further development.	• Exegesis (750 words) critically evaluates successes, challenges, and growth. • Reflection identifies strategies for ongoing development. • References at least one authoritative source (APA7) linking research to practice.

Required Readings

Dobson, M., & Wilson, S. B. (2008). Goal setting: How to create an action plan and achieve your goals. AMACOM.

Miller, S. (2020). Career management for artists: A practical guide to representation and sustainability for your studio practice. Routledge.

Segal, G. Z. (2015). Getting there: A book of mentors. Abrams.

Recommended Readings

Burkeman, O. (2022). Four thousand weeks: Time management for mortals. Random House.

Cameron, J. (2016). The artist's way: A spiritual path to higher creativity. TarcherPerigee.

Clear, J. (2018). Atomic habits: Tiny changes, remarkable results. Random House Business.

Duckworth, A. (2018). Grit: The power of passion and perseverance. Scribner.

Dweck, C. S. (2016). Mindset: The new psychology of success. Ballantine Books.

Dyer, J., Gregersen, H., & Christensen, C. M. (2019). The innovator's DNA: Mastering the five skills of disruptive innovators. Harvard Business School Press.

Pressfield, S., & McKee, R. (2012). The war of art: Break through the blocks and win your inner creative battles. Black Irish Entertainment.

Questlove, & Greenman, B. (2018). Creative quest. Ecco.

Rubin, R., & Strauss, N. (2023). The creative act: A way of being. Penguin Press.

Schwarzenegger, A. (2023). Be useful: Seven tools for life. Ebury Edge.

Specialised Resource Requirements

- Word Processor
- Presentation Software
- Internet Access
- Software: Discipline Relative Creation Software
- Mac computers

AI Assessment Scale

Level & Category	Description	Application in Creative Industries	Activities
Level 1 - No AI	Students do not use AI tools in their creative process.	Suitable for projects requiring personal expression, original craftsmanship, or the demonstration of foundational creative skills.	Activities: sketching, hand-drawing, analog photography, live performance, in-person critiques.
Level 2- AI-Assisted Idea Generation and Structuring	AI is used for brainstorming and organising ideas, but final creative work must be original and human-authored.	Useful for concept development, mood boards, and initial drafts in design, writing, or multimedia projects, developing effective feedback language.	Activities: collaborative brainstorming, creating project outlines, mood boards, AI-assisted research for inspiration, framing feedback for peers constructively.
		Beneficial for polishing content such as	

Level 3- AI-Assisted Editing	Students use AI for refining, editing, or enhancing their creative outputs.	graphic design, music production, or film editing. AI assists with technical adjustments, but the creative vision remains human-directed.	Activities: correcting grammar/spelling in scripts, adjusting image filters, fine-tuning sound mixing, visual editing.
Level 4- AI-Enhanced Creative Task Completion	AI tools are integrated into specific aspects of creative projects, with students critically evaluating AI outputs and integrating them into their work.	Encourages exploration of AI as a collaborative partner in tasks like generating visual effects, automating repetitive tasks, or experimenting with generative design.	Activities: AI-generated visuals or music, comparative analysis of AI vs. human work, critical evaluation of AI-generated content, blending AI outputs with human creativity.
Level 5- Full AI Integration	AI is fully integrated throughout the creative process, allowing for deep exploration and innovation.	Suitable for experimental projects where AI plays a central role, pushing boundaries of creativity and exploring new mediums or methods.	Activities: co-creating with AI (e.g., generative art, AI-driven music composition), real-time collaboration with AI tools, iterative feedback loops, AI as a creative tool in producing final projects.

Perkins, M., Furze, L., Roe, J., & MacVaugh, J. (2024). The artificial intelligence assessment scale (AIAS): A framework for ethical integration of generative AI in educational assessment. *Journal of University Teaching and Learning Practice*, 21(06).
<https://doi.org/10.53761/q3azde36>

